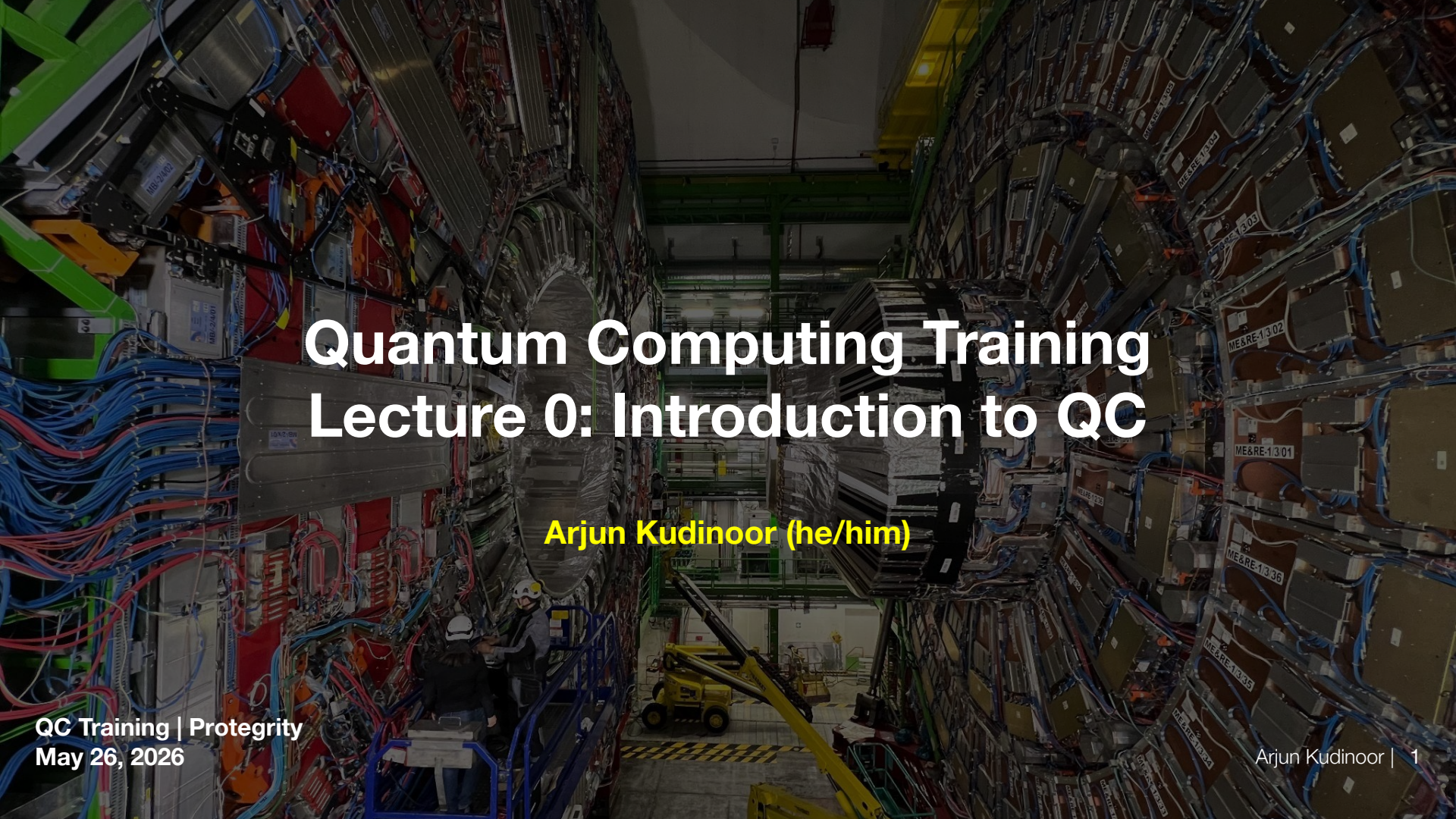




# Quantum Computing Training Lecture 0: Introduction to QC

Arjun Kudinoor (he/him)

# A Little Bit About Me



## **PhD Candidate at the MIT**

Research on theoretical particle/nuclear physics

## **BA at Columbia University (CC '23)**

I co-taught and co-authored curriculum for the Quantum Computing course taken by physics majors

## **Advisor at Protegrity since March 2025**

I help build knowledge of, expertise in, and implementation of quantum computing and quantum-safe encryption



A dark, atmospheric photograph of the MIT dome at night, with the building's lights glowing and the surrounding trees silhouetted against a dark sky. The text is overlaid in the center.

# CRYPTOGRAPHIC AND QUANTUM REVOLUTIONS

# 1977: R,S, and A establish RSA



Ron Rivest



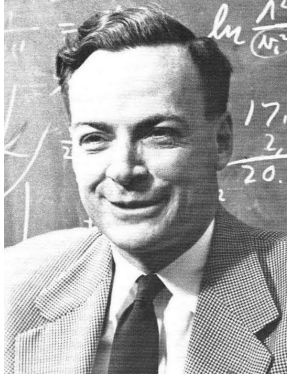
Adi Shamir



Leonard Adleman



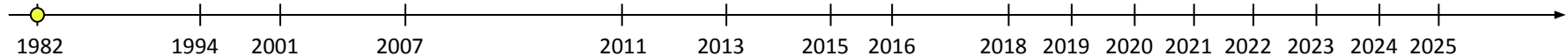
# 1982: Feynman's Idea for Quantum Computation



Richard Feynman  
(Caltech)

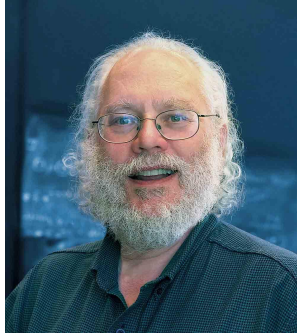
Richard Feynman proposed a new type of computer, a quantum computer

- “It is impossible to represent the results of quantum mechanics with a classical universal device”
- The number of degrees of freedom in a system of  $N$  quantum mechanical particles scales exponentially with  $N$
- To truly simulate quantum systems, you need a quantum computer



[1] [Feynman's Keynote Address](#)

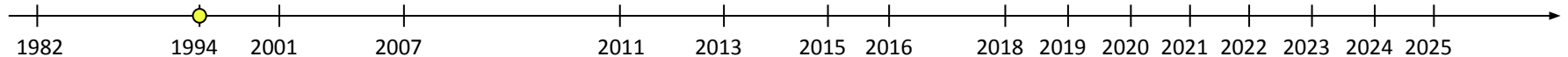
# 1994: Shor's Factoring Algorithm



Peter Shor (MIT)

Peter Shor formulated the Shor Algorithm. It factorizes integers exponentially faster than the fastest known classical algorithm

- Threatens factorization-based cryptography
- Threatens elliptic curve discrete log cryptography
- Threatens the encryption of almost all information sent over the internet



# 2001: Shor's Algorithm is realized on a Quantum "Device"



Ike Chuang (MIT)

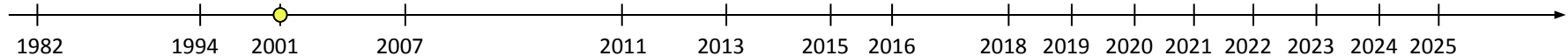


Lieven  
Vandersypen  
(QuTech @ Delft)

**Isaac Chuang, Lieven Vandersypen, and IBM factorize 15**

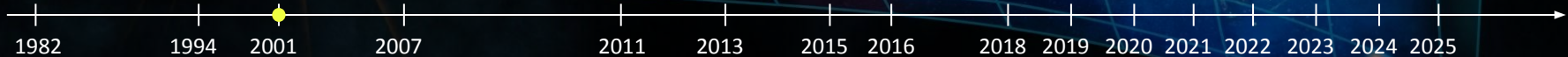
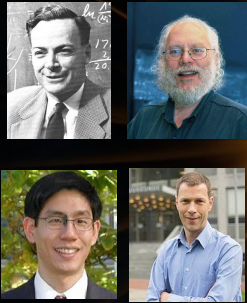
- Engineered a special molecule  $\Rightarrow$  a tiny quantum computer
- Used nuclear magnetic resonance to modify spin states and perform computations
- First physical demonstration of Shor's algorithm!

**The first-step to breaking factorization-based encryption, like RSA**





# The Big Bang of Quantum Computing





# How Many Qubits to Break RSA-2048?



1000 error-free quantum  
O(1000) error-free  
quantum bits to  
break RSA-2048



$2^{1000}$  binary bits to simulate  
the computer  
Equivalent to  $2^{1001}$   
classical bits



Only  $2^{265}$  atoms in  
 $2^{265}$  atoms in the  
visible universe

# How Many Qubits to Break RSA-2048?

## The Pinnacle Architecture: Reducing the cost of breaking RSA-2048 to 100 000 physical qubits using quantum LDPC codes

Paul Webster,<sup>\*</sup> Lucas Berent, Omprakash Chandra, Evan T. Hockings,  
Nouédyne Baspin, Felix Thomsen, Samuel C. Smith, and Lawrence Z. Cohen<sup>†</sup>  
*Iceberg Quantum, Sydney*

The realisation of utility-scale quantum computing inextricably depends on the design of practical, low-overhead fault-tolerant architectures. We introduce the *Pinnacle Architecture*, which uses quantum low-density parity check (QLDPC) codes to allow for universal, fault-tolerant quantum computation with a spacetime overhead significantly smaller than that of any competing architecture. With this architecture, we show that 2048-bit RSA integers can be factored with less than one hundred thousand physical qubits, given a physical error rate of  $10^{-3}$ , code cycle time of 1  $\mu$ s and a reaction time of 10  $\mu$ s. We thereby demonstrate the feasibility of utility-scale quantum computing with an order of magnitude fewer physical qubits than has previously been believed necessary.



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## Shor's algorithm is possible with as few as 10,000 reconfigurable atomic qubits

Madelyn Cain<sup>1,\*†</sup>, Qian Xu<sup>1,2,\*†</sup>, Robbie King<sup>1</sup>, Lewis R.B. Picard<sup>1</sup>, Harry Levine<sup>1,3</sup>,  
Manuel Endres<sup>1,2</sup>, John Preskill<sup>1,2</sup>, Hsin-Yuan Huang<sup>1,2</sup>, Dolev Bluvstein<sup>1,2,§</sup>  
<sup>1</sup>Oratomic, Pasadena, California 91135, USA

<sup>2</sup>California Institute of Technology, Pasadena, California 91125, USA

<sup>3</sup>Department of Physics, University of California, Berkeley, California 94720, USA

<sup>†</sup>mcain@oratomic.com, <sup>§</sup>qxu@oratomic.com, <sup>§</sup>dbluvstein@oratomic.com

<sup>\*</sup>These authors contributed equally

(Dated: March 31, 2026)

Quantum computers have the potential to perform computational tasks beyond the reach of classical machines. A prominent example is Shor's algorithm for integer factorization and discrete logarithms, which is of both fundamental importance and practical relevance to cryptography. However, due to the high overhead of quantum error correction, optimized resource estimates for cryptographically relevant instances of Shor's algorithm require millions of physical qubits. Here, by leveraging advances in high-rate quantum error-correcting codes, efficient logical instruction sets, and circuit design, we show that Shor's algorithm can be executed at cryptographically relevant scales with as few as 10,000 reconfigurable atomic qubits. Increasing the number of physical qubits improves time efficiency by enabling greater parallelism; under plausible assumptions, the runtime for discrete logarithms on the P-256 elliptic curve could be just a few days for a system with 26,000 physical qubits, while the runtime for factoring RSA-2048 integers is one to two orders of magnitude longer. Recent neutral-atom experiments have demonstrated universal fault-tolerant operations below the error-correction threshold, computation on arrays of hundreds of qubits, and trapping arrays with more than 6,000 highly coherent qubits. Although substantial engineering challenges remain, our theoretical analysis indicates that an appropriately designed neutral-atom architecture could support quantum computation at cryptographically relevant scales. More broadly, these results highlight the capability of neutral atoms for fault-tolerant quantum computing with wide-ranging scientific and technological applications.

## Theory: 100,000 “Noisy” Qubits to Break RSA-2048

## Experiment: Largest commercial QCs have ~1,000 qubits with MUCH larger noise (error rates)

# Opportunities

Credit: Scott Aaronson's Public APS Talk

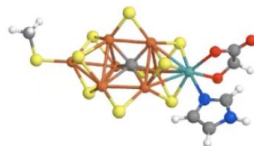
## Caveat: “QC works” $\neq$ “QC speeds up your application”!!

Finding clear real-world applications of QC, beyond the “Big Three,” remains as much of a challenge as ever

### 1. Breaking Current Public-Key Cryptography



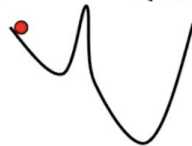
### 2. Simulating Quantum Physics and Chemistry



### 3. Everything Else...



HHL,  
QAOA





# Many Topics To Discuss...

## Week 1

- Qubits, gates, and circuits
- Entanglement and Quantum Teleportation
- First example of quantum advantage: Simon's algorithm

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- Shor's Factoring Algorithm

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## Week 3 (TBD...)

- Discrete Log Algorithm
- **Grover's Search Algorithm**
- **Quantum Encryption via BB84**
- **Quantum Optimization Algorithms**
- Quantum Error Correction
- Post-quantum (classical) cryptography

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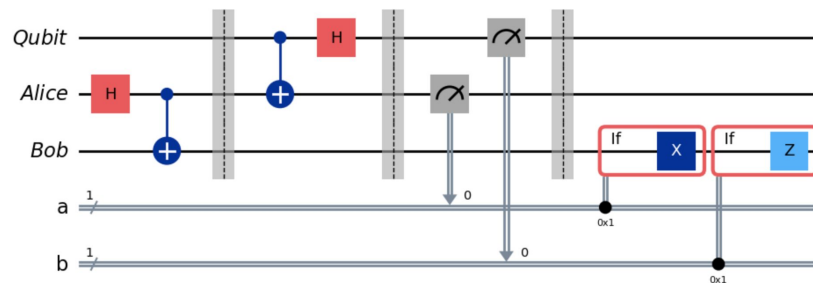


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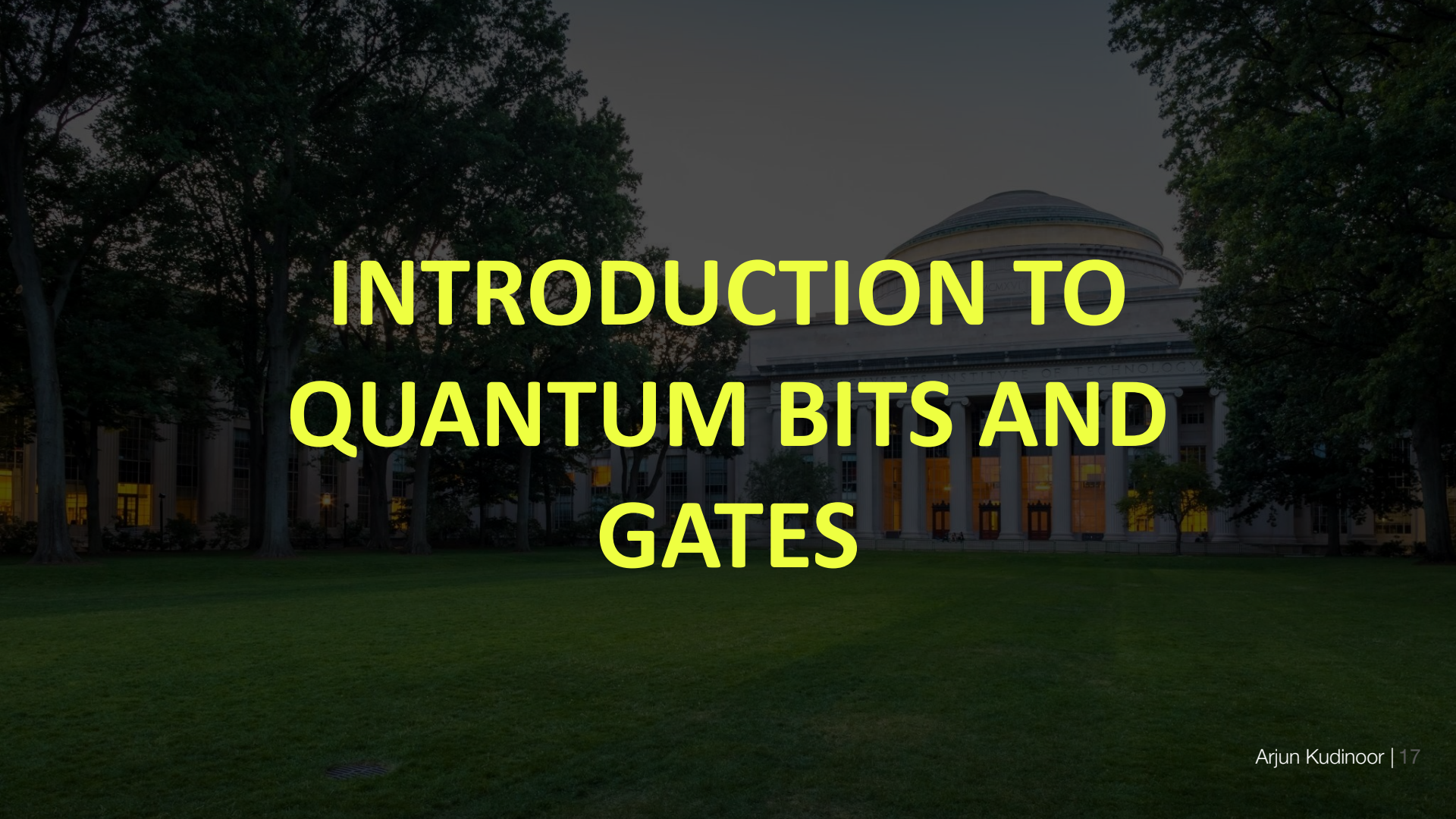
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# Ground Rules

- 1) **Let's have fun!**
- 2) **Help each other**
  - a) Ask questions
  - b) Be engaged
- 3) **Do the homeworks (due before each following lecture)**
  - a) Collaboration will be necessary
  - b) Explore, explore, explore
- 4) **The use of AI is allowed and encouraged**
  - a) Document your use (prompts, responses, etc.)
  - b) Write up your own solution – handwritten when it is not code

A photograph of the MIT dome at night, with the building's interior lights glowing and the surrounding trees in silhouette. The title text is overlaid in the center.

# INTRODUCTION TO QUANTUM BITS AND GATES

# Classical and Quantum Bits

## Classical Bits

Binary value of 0 or 1

0



1



# Classical and Quantum Bits

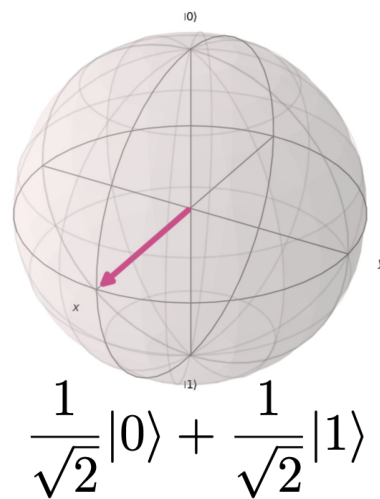
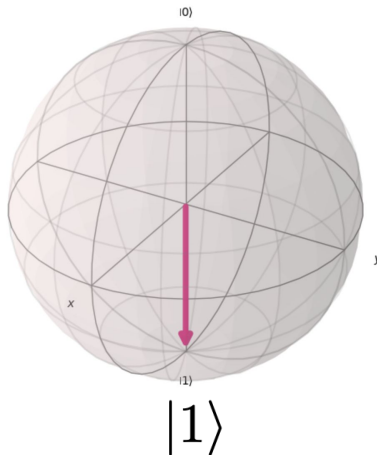
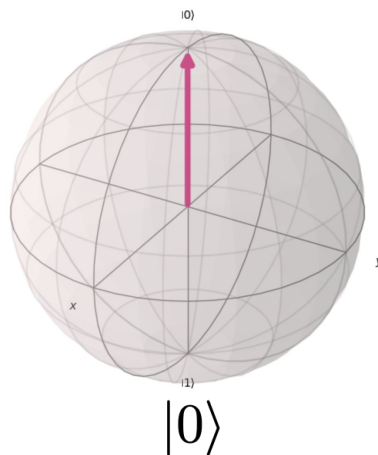
## Classical Bits

Binary value of 0 or 1



## Quantum bits (qubits)

**“Superposition state”**  $|\psi\rangle = a|0\rangle + b|1\rangle$



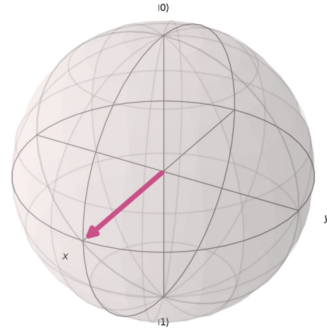
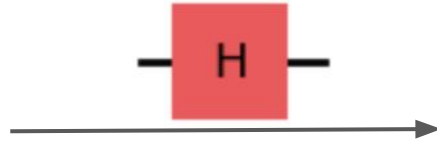
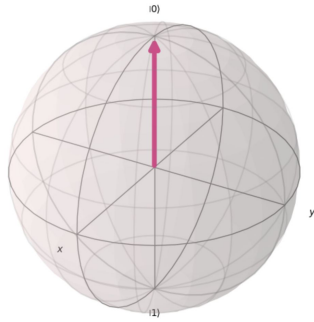
# Reading from a Qubit (Measurement)

**The quantum state of a single qubit is not directly readable**

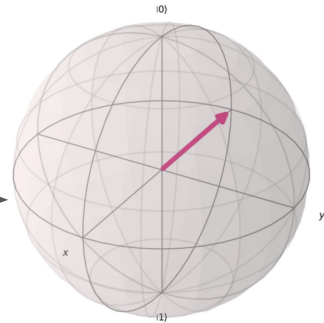
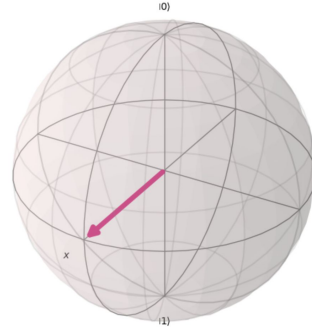
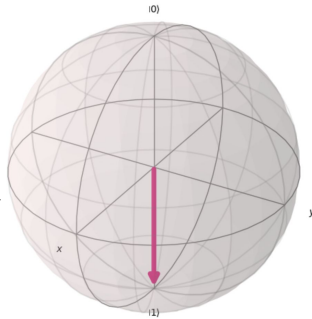
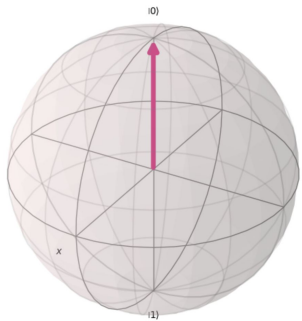
- When you measure a qubit, you can only read a classical bit value of 0 or 1
  - The quantum state “collapses” to 0 or 1
- Suppose you have many qubits with the same quantum state  $|\psi\rangle = a|0\rangle + b|1\rangle$
- Measure all of them – you will get roughly
  - $|a|^2$  number of 0's
  - $|b|^2$  number of 1's
- Quantum mechanics is probabilistic  $\Rightarrow$  Learning the state of a qubit with good accuracy requires a LOT of identical qubits!



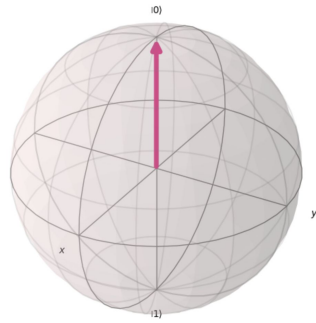
# Writing to a Qubit (Quantum Gates)



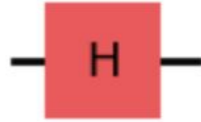
**You can write  
information to qubits  
using quantum gates**



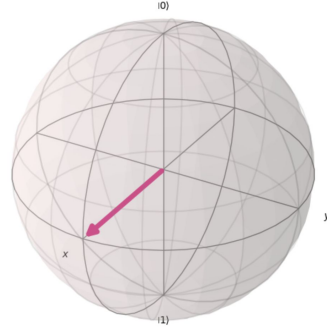
# Writing to a Qubit (Quantum Gates)



$$|0\rangle = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$$



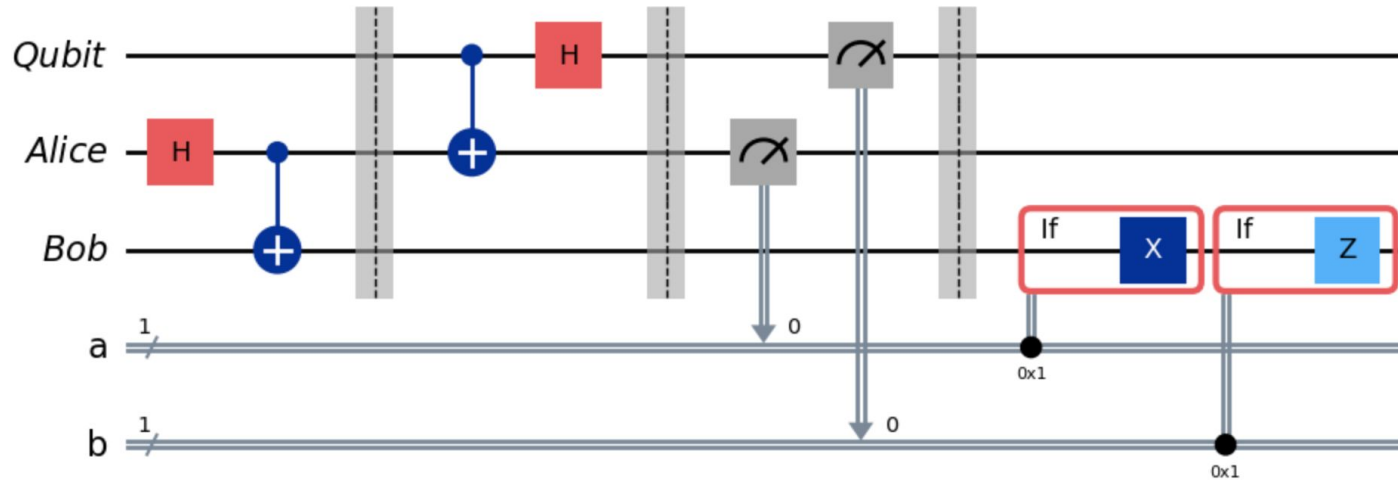
$$H|0\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$$



$$\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}|0\rangle + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}|1\rangle$$

**Quantum gates are just matrix operations on quantum state-vectors**

# Quantum Circuits



You can manipulate quantum information using circuits, a sequence of quantum gates acting on multiple qubits

**Quantum gate operations on multiple qubits  
⇒ Transfers and entangles information between qubits**

# Entanglement

$$|\psi\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|00\rangle + |11\rangle)$$

- If we measure one qubit to be 0  $\Rightarrow$  The other qubit must also be 0 upon measurement
- If we measure one qubit to be 1  $\Rightarrow$  The other qubit must also be 1 upon measurement

**Two entangled qubits contain perfectly correlated information**

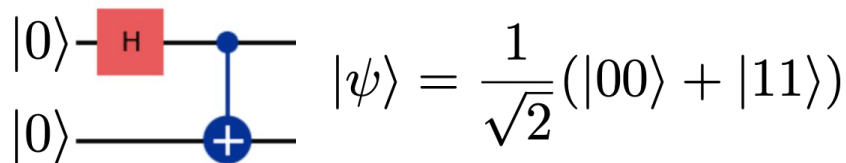
```
from qiskit import QuantumCircuit, QuantumRegister

qubit0 = QuantumRegister(1, "qubit_0")
qubit1 = QuantumRegister(1, "qubit_1")

protocol = QuantumCircuit(qubit0, qubit1)

# Perform gate operations that entangle qubits
protocol.h(qubit0)
protocol.cx(qubit0, qubit1)

display(protocol.draw(output="mpl"))
```



# Entanglement in Practice

$$|\psi\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|00\rangle + |11\rangle)$$

